

Types of cell

There are around 200 different types of cell in a human body, each with its own job to do. Cells of the same type work together in groups called tissues. The size and shape of cells are linked to the specific roles they perform.

Cell variety

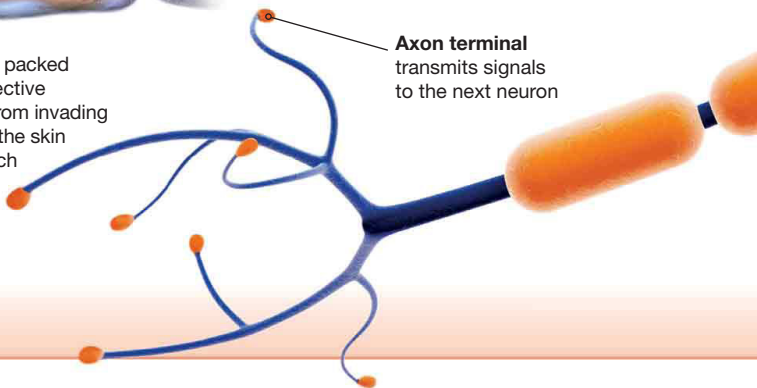
The six types of body cell shown here all have very different shapes and roles. For example, thin nerve cells carry signals over long distances, allowing the brain to communicate with other parts of the body, while round adipose cells store fuel.



Epithelial cells are tightly packed together and form a protective barrier that stops germs from invading body tissues. They cover the skin and line hollow organs such as the mouth and lungs.



Red blood cells travel around the body in the blood. They are small and, unlike other cells, do not have a nucleus. They give blood its red color and carry oxygen from the lungs to all other cells.



Axon terminal
transmits signals
to the next neuron